

SWINGING HIGH

KIDAMBI SRIKANTH, 28

Badminton player, **Hyderabad**

On December 19, Kidambi Srikanth won silver at the Badminton World Federation (BWF) World Championships, held in Huelva, Spain, scripting history as the first Indian man to have won a World Championship silver. It helped him move up four places in the latest BWF rankings to No. 10. Srikanth, who has clinched titles in four Super Series in Indonesia, Australia, Denmark and France, is the only Indian, and fourth overall, to win all in a calendar year. Despite the setbacks served by the pandemic and injuries, Srikanth is busy setting bigger goals for himself. He has a packed schedule ahead—India Open in January, the all-England, the World Championship and the Asian Games. "No time to rest," he says. Srikanth will be focusing on bettering his form and fitness at the Pullela Gopichand Badminton Academy in Hyderabad where he has been training. ■

–Amarnath K. Menon

BETTER THAN THE BEST Kidambi Srikanth has outperformed even the greats. Prakash Padukone (1983), B. Sai Praneeth (2019) and Lakshya Sen (2021) all lost in their respective BWF semi-finals to settle for bronze medals.

"He is not swayed by the success that has followed months of toiling and heartbreak, the biggest one being the Olympic Games"

PULLELA GOPICHAND
Chief National Coach, Indian Badminton Team

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